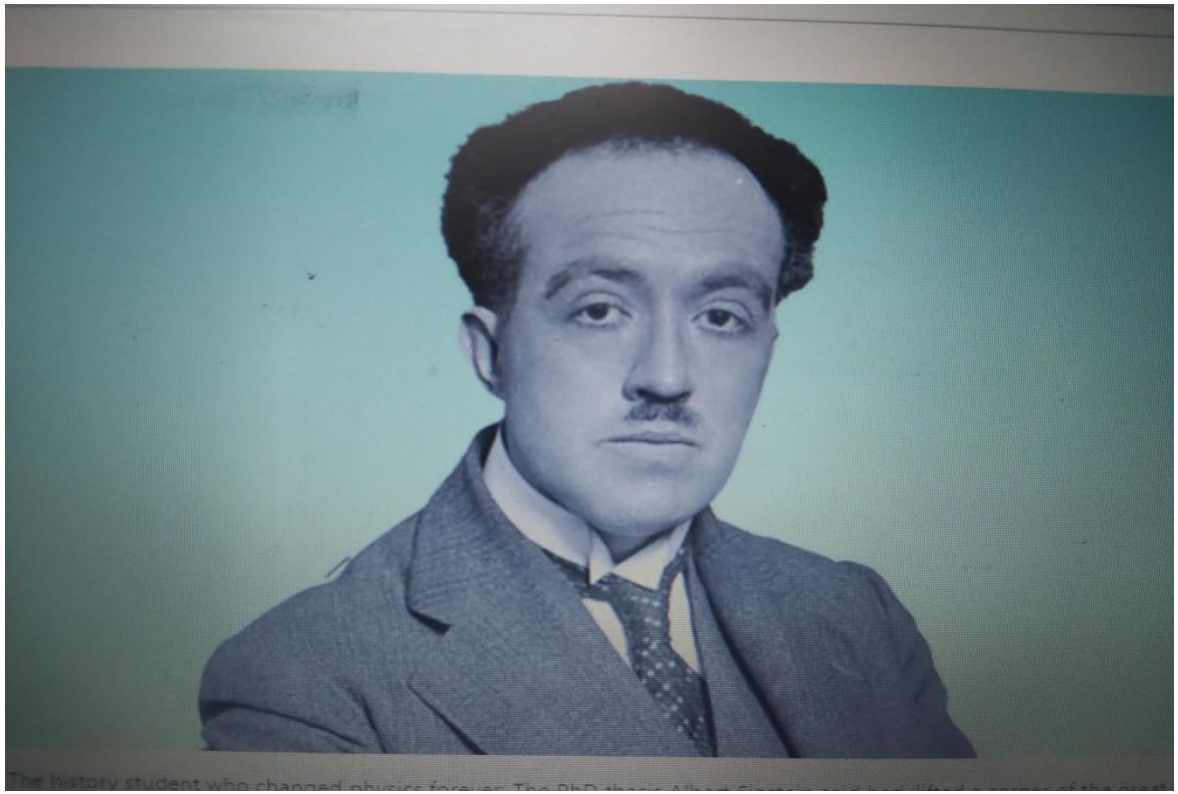
Achieving Academic Excellence In Higher Education Institutions: An Overview

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How academic ecosystem help to transform ?



Quality? How to measure?

- Quality in Automobile manufacturing industry?
- Quality in Academic Institution?

NAAC visit?

- Academic quality is measured by data?
- Data on everything?
- Pain-staking process to collect (student enrollment, student placement, faculty research, project, so on so on……. Numerous spread-sheets…..

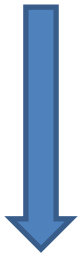
What can not be measured does not seems to exist???

What research says?

- Numerous studies have shown that quality in an academic institution can not be measured solely by numbers.
- Data can be of use.
- Quantitative data supports the precision and accuracy – that's true, but…..

may be deceptive

Matrices can help only if they do not replace judgment which is based on experience



What’s the way out??

Holistic Analysis



- This can remove the singular obsession with ranking table
- Can remove the inherent mistrust of academicians which seems to prevail among education administrators.

Quality?

- Honoring the code of culture of academic integrity in the classroom – individually, collectively.

- The term *academic integrity* means a commitment to a set of fundamental values that support research, learning, scholarship, and service in academia.

How?

- Mindset
- Trust-based leadership
- Well-designed system/A disciplined system

- Design brings discipline & discipline bring excellence

Concept of Academic Quality

- Enablers:

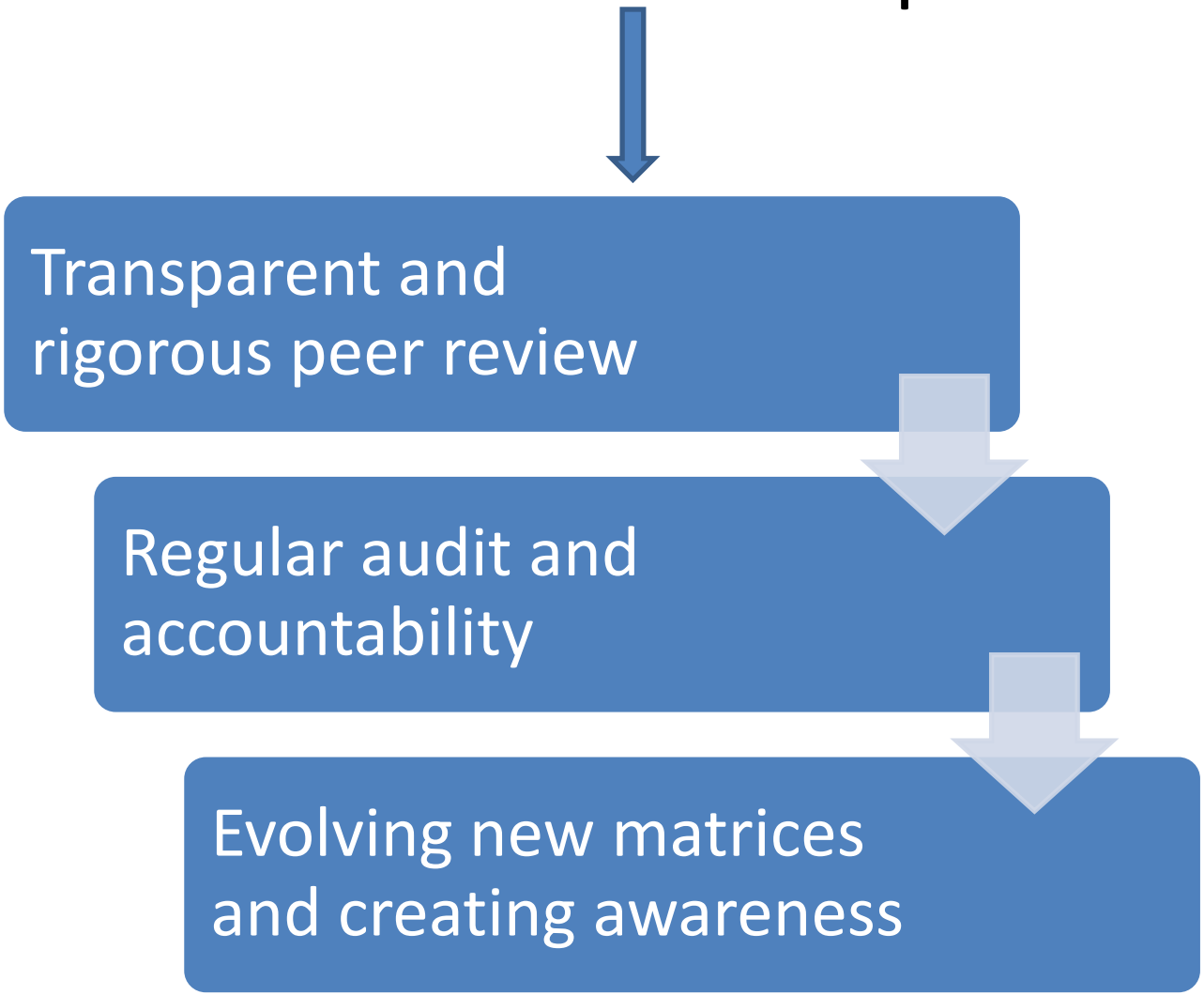
Policy initiative
Global Ranking
Internationalization of curriculum
Academic exchange
Digitalization
Institutional Strategies
Multiculturalism
Safety & Security
Employer relationship & Future job opprotunities
Individual development

Inter-relationship diagram



Doi.10.1007/978-94-6351-161-2_61

Ranking – objective is to restore integrity and ensure sustainable practices



Role of IQAC in maintaining quality standards in teaching, learning and evaluation

- Maintaining overall quality standard
- Functioning as an administrative quality monitoring body.
- To analyze and workout various opinions of coordinators and non-members of IQAC
- To find out solutions to issues/problems.

Examples: Parameters

- Contribution of IQAC in teaching, learning & evaluation
- Organization of co-curricular, extra-curricular and other types of activities
- Response to academic activities sponsored by IQAC from the rest of the teaching and non-teaching/support staff
- Coordination among IQAC and various departments
- Orientation, refresher and other short-term training courses for teaching and non-teaching
- Presenting working strategy and its implementation
- Overall satisfaction with the functioning of IQAC

A good reference

1. Quality Higher Education and Sustainable Development: NAAC Decennial Lectures.
2. Quality Indicators for Teacher Education, An Anthology of Best Practices in Teacher Education, International Perspectives on Student Participation in Quality Enhancement, Quality Assurance in Higher Education: An Introduction, Higher Education: Challenges and Vision edited by Dr. Chitra Naik *et al*.

Framework for Outcome Based Accreditation and Rankings

- NBA, NAAC, NIRF
- Own framework to measure the quality of the academic education system for Accreditation and Rankings respectively.
- The criteria, key aspects and indicators are different but overlapping.
- These differences in assessment are making the institutions to work for three different models concentrating in the core academics.

NAAC Criteria

1. Curricular Aspects
2. Teaching Learning & Evaluations
3. Research Innovations & extensions
4. Infrastructure & Learning Resources
5. Students support and Progressions
6. Governance, Leadership and Management
7. Institutional Values and Best Practices

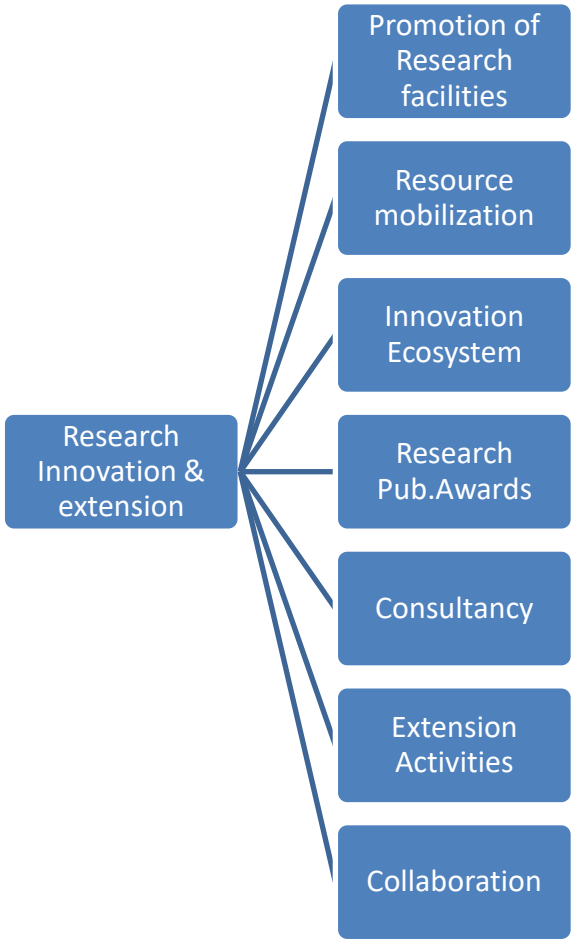
NAAC- Distribution of weightage(s), 7 criteria, 34 key indicators

Criteria	Key Indicators	Universities	Auto.Colleges	Affiliated Colleges
Curricular Aspects	1.1 Curriculum Design & Dev.	50	50	NA
	1.2. Curr.Planning & Implementations	NA	NA	20
	1.3. Acad.flexibility	50	40	30
	1.4. Curr.Enrichment	30	40	30
	1.5. Feed back	20	20	20
		150	150	150

NAAC

Criteria	KIs	Univ.	College	Affi.College
Teaching, Learning & Evaluation	2.1. Student enrol. profile	10	20	30
	2.2. Student diversity	20	30	50
	2.3. Teaching Learning	20	50	50
	2.4. Teacher Profile	50	60	80
	2.5. Evaluation Process, Reform	40	40	50
	2.6.Stud.Perf. Learning outcome	30	50	40
	2.7.Student Satisfaction survey	30	50	50
		200	300	350

NAAC



Combining all criteria, the Total score is 1000

NIRF

1. The NIRF Methodology is based on developing a set of metrics for ranking of academic institutions.

2. These parameters are organized into five broad heads, and have been further elaborated into suitable sub-heads.

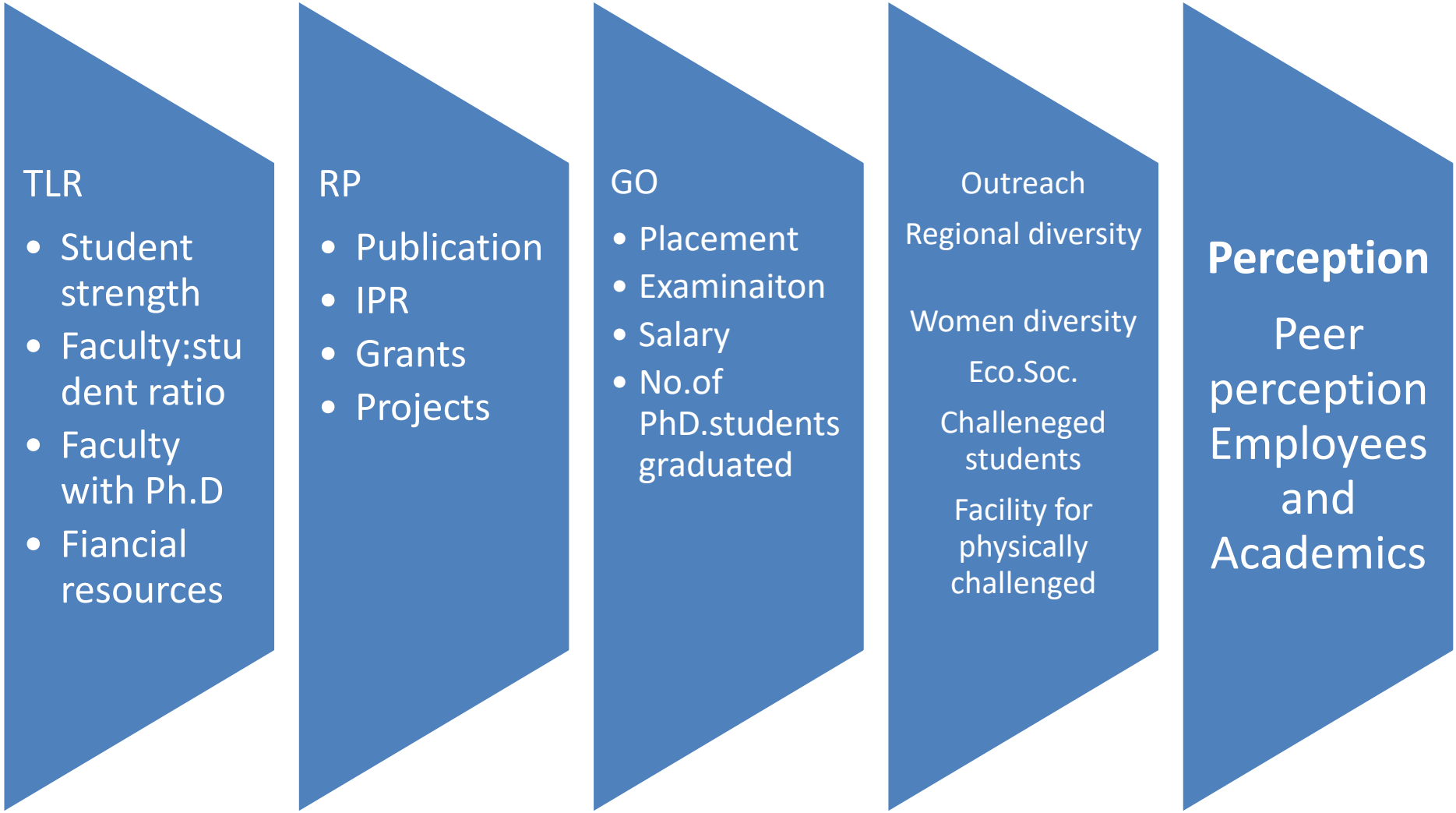
3. Each broad head has an overall weight assigned to it. Within each head, the various sub-heads also have an appropriate weight distribution

NIRF



Total score: 500

NIRF


TLR
• Student strength
• Faculty:student ratio
• Faculty with Ph.D
• Fiancial resources
RP
• Publication
• IPR
• Grants
• Projects
GO
• Placement
• Examinaiton
• Salary
• No.of PhD.students graduated
Outreach
Regional diversity
Women diversity
Eco.Soc.
Challeneged students
Facility for physically challenged
Perception
Peer perception Employees and Academics

NBA

The NBA Self-Assessment Report consists generally two parts namely Part-A and Part-B. Part-A mainly seeks general information about the institute and department /programme. Part-B seeks information based on 10 broad criteria.

Vision mission & prog.edu.objective	• Dept/institute • PEOs • PEOs dissiminated among stakeholders • Procsss of defining vision mission of Dept./PEOs • Establish consistency of PEOs with vision mission
Prog.curric.&teaching learning processes	• State the process of designing • Structure of curriculum • State the component of curriculum • Process for attainment of POs PEOs • Process followed the improve the quality of teaching learning • Quality of End sem exam, int. question paper • Quality of student project • Initiative to industry interaction • Internship/summer training

NBA

Course outcomes & Programme outcomes

- Correlation between courses and PO
- Attainment of course outcome
- Attainment of PO and programme specific outcomes

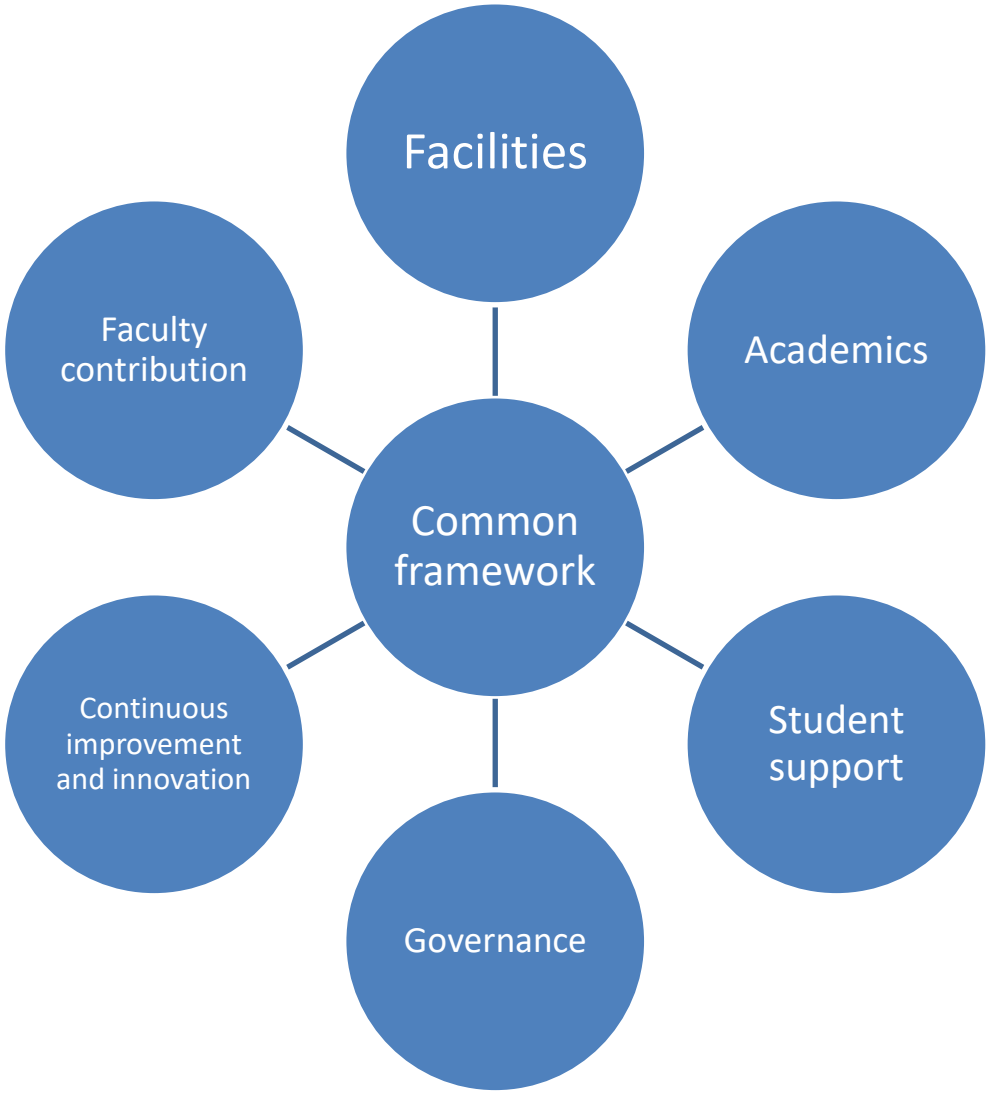
Students performance

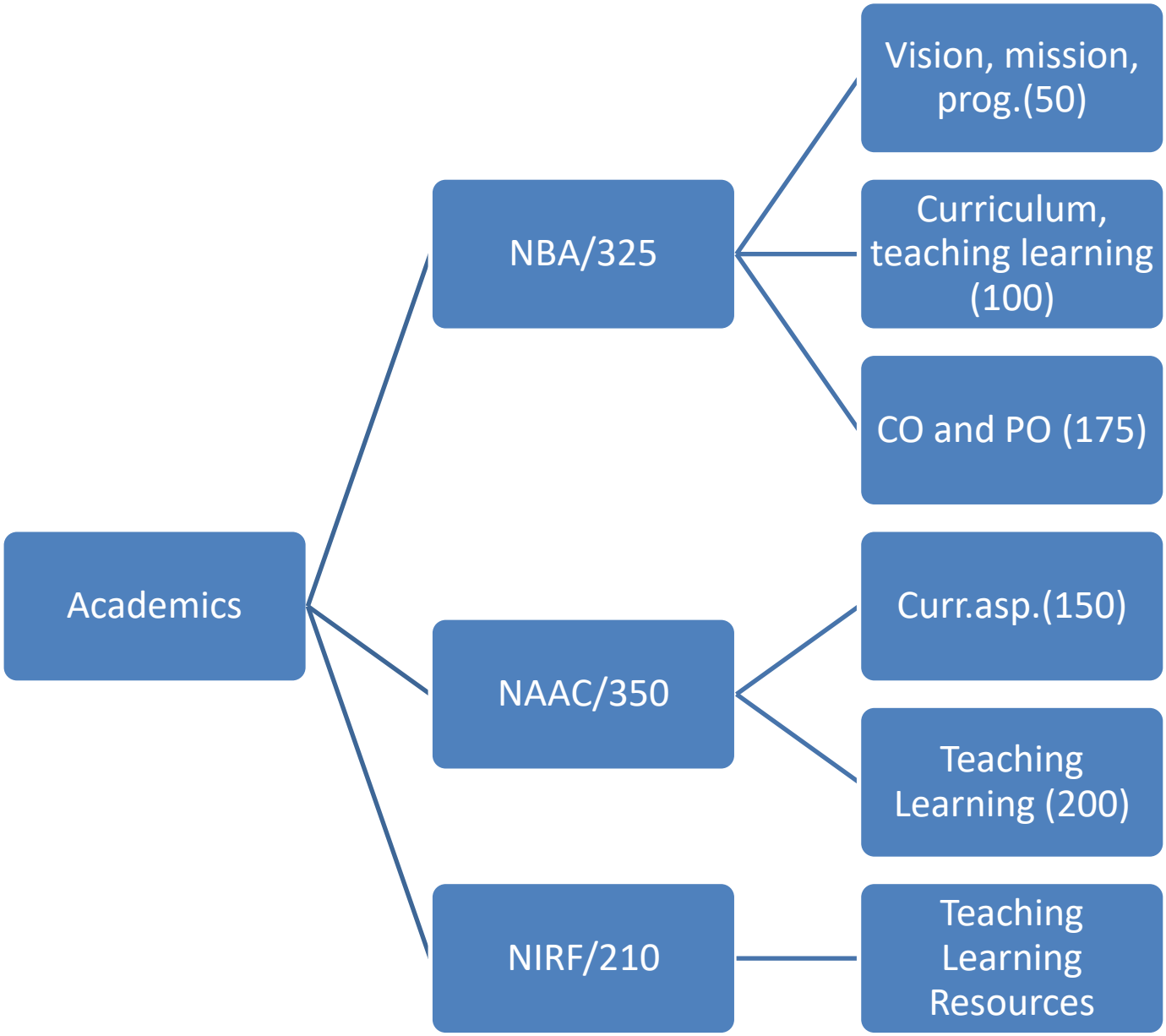
- Enrollment ratio
- Success rate in the stipulated programme
- Academic performance
- Placement, higher studies and entrepreneurship
- Professional activities

Can there be a common framework?



Yes, it is possible. But How???




Academics
NBA/325
Vision, mission, prog.(50)
Curriculum, teaching learning (100)
CO and PO (175)
NAAC/350
Curr.asp.(150)
Teaching Learning (200)
NIRF/210
Teaching Learning Resources

	NBA	NAAC	NIRF
Facilities	Facilities, tech. support (80)	Infra.learning resouces (100)	Teaching learning and outreach (120)
Faculty contribution	Faculty info.contribution (200)	Res.Inno.Extn (250)	Res.&Professornal pract. (300)
Student support	Student perf + Acad + support (200)	Stud. Support Prog.(100)	Graduation outcome (200)
Governance	Govrn.+ Inst.support+Finan. Resources (120)	Govn.Leadership and Mgt (100)	Outreach and inclusivity (80)
Continuous Improvement and Practice	Cont. Improv. (75)	Inst. Values & Best Pract (100)	Perception (100)
	1000	**1000**	**1000**

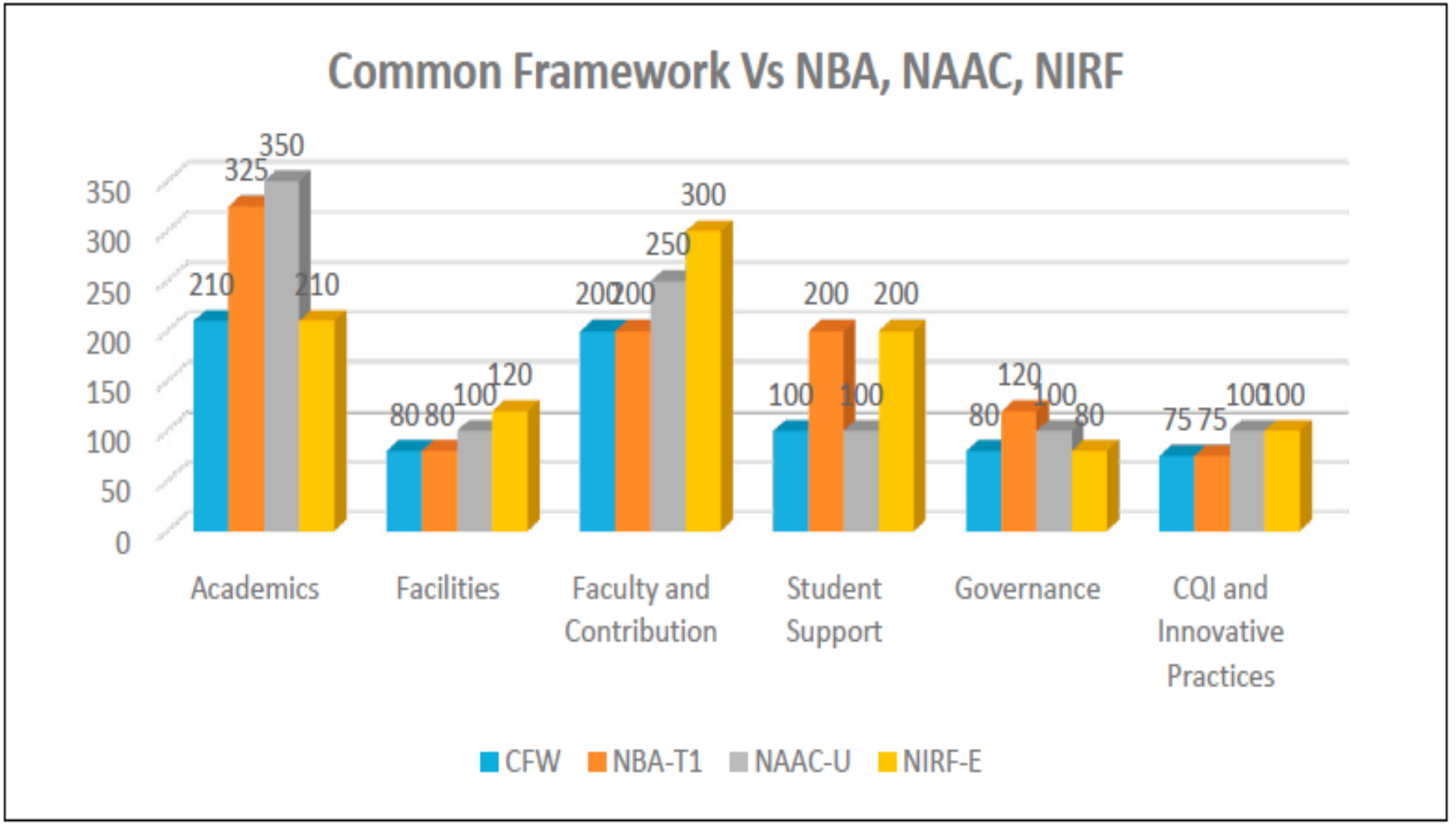


Fig. 1. The Common Framework Vs NBA, NAAC, NIRF

How can you achieve excellence?

- Choice defined the model – Academics always choose most compatible one.
- How can you derive the value from your strategic plan?
- Building trust – the operating system to achieve excellence.

NAAC binary system



Objectives of the Binary System: The Binary System of Accreditation, launched in 2024, aims to transform the accreditation landscape for Indian HEIs. Its key objectives include:

- Simplify the Process: Streamline the complex grading system into a straightforward "Accredited" or "Not Accredited"
- Increase Coverage: Boost accreditation.
- Enhance Transparency: Improve credibility by minimizing subjectivity and malpractices through automated Data Validation and Verification (DVV) and digital tools.

NAAC binary system

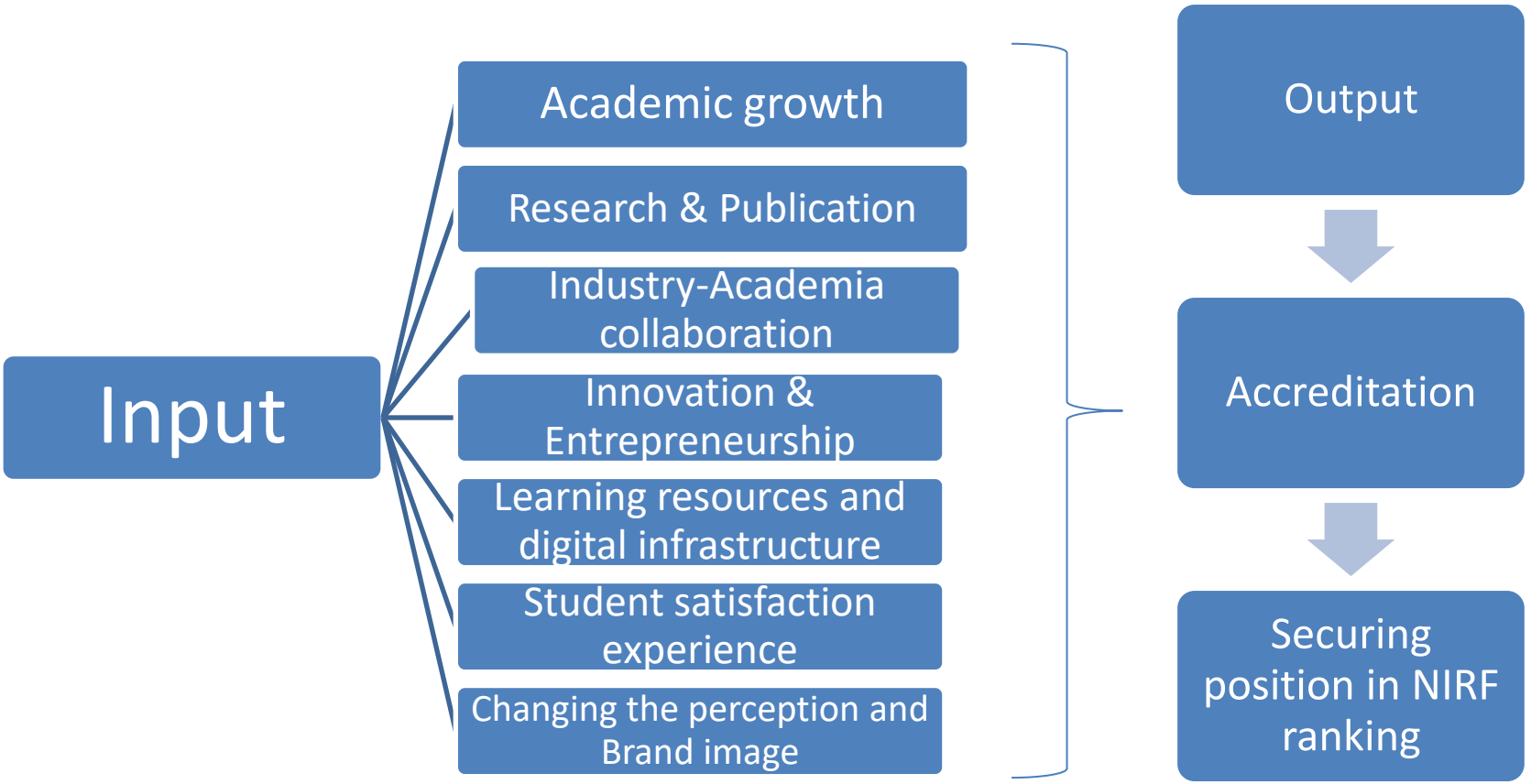
● Promote Quality Improvement: Establish baseline quality via binary outcomes and encourage progression through Maturity-Based Graded Levels (MBGL, Levels 1-5), with Level 5 for global excellence.

● Align with Global Standards: Support NEP 2020's vision by aligning with international benchmarks (e.g., Washington Accord), enhancing global competitiveness and mobility.

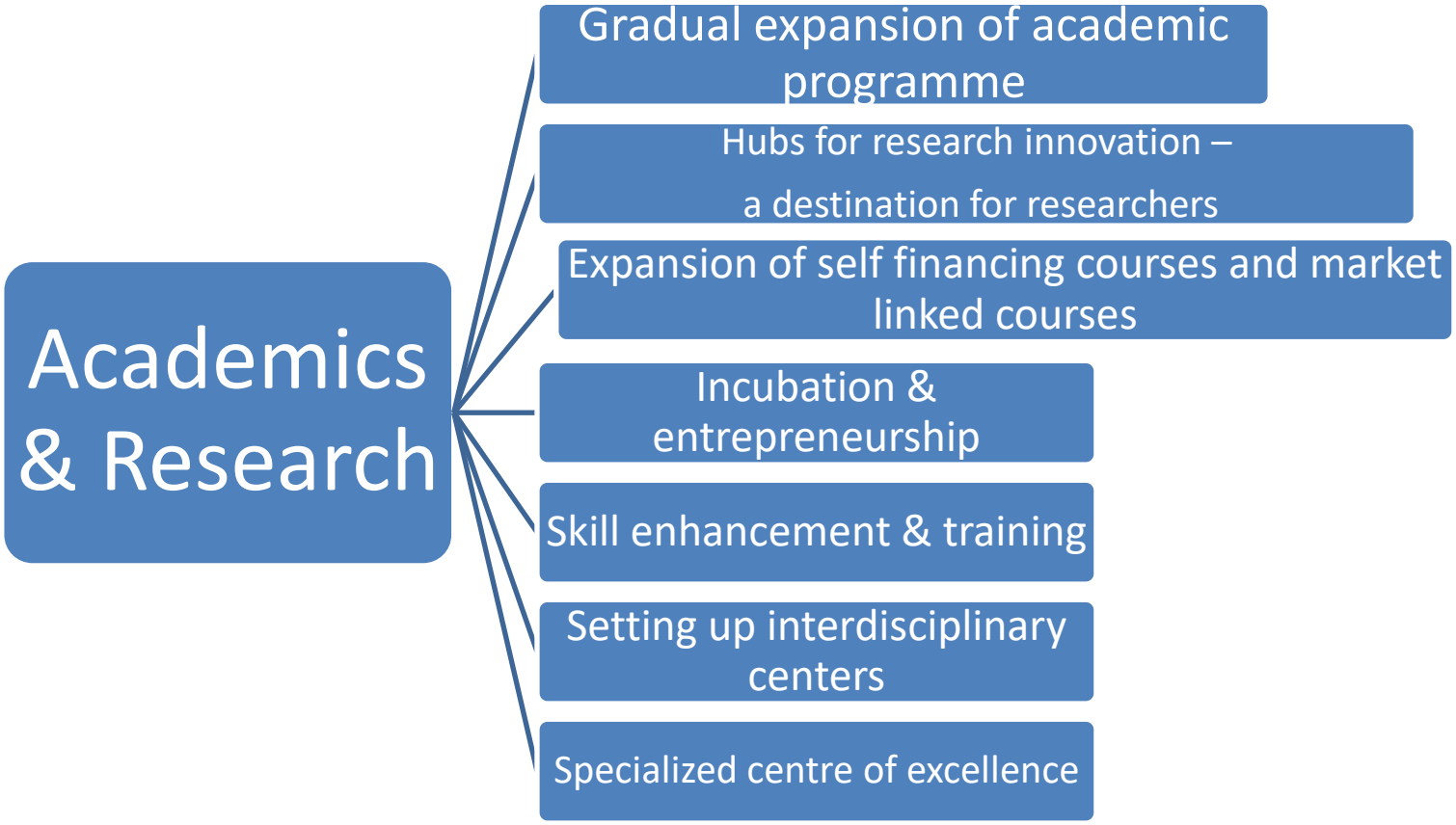
● Ensure Inclusivity: Make accreditation accessible to diverse HEIs, including rural institutions, through reduced costs and mentoring .

● Facilitate Funding and Autonomy: Enable accredited HEIs to access UGC grants, autonomy, and credibility, fostering academic and financial growth.

Roadmap


Input
Academic growth
Research & Publication
Industry-Academia collaboration
Innovation & Entrepreneurship
Learning resources and digital infrastructure
Student satisfaction experience
Changing the perception and Brand image
Output
Accreditation
Securing position in NIRF ranking

Roadmap – focusing parameters



An example of Curriculum development – Management Studies

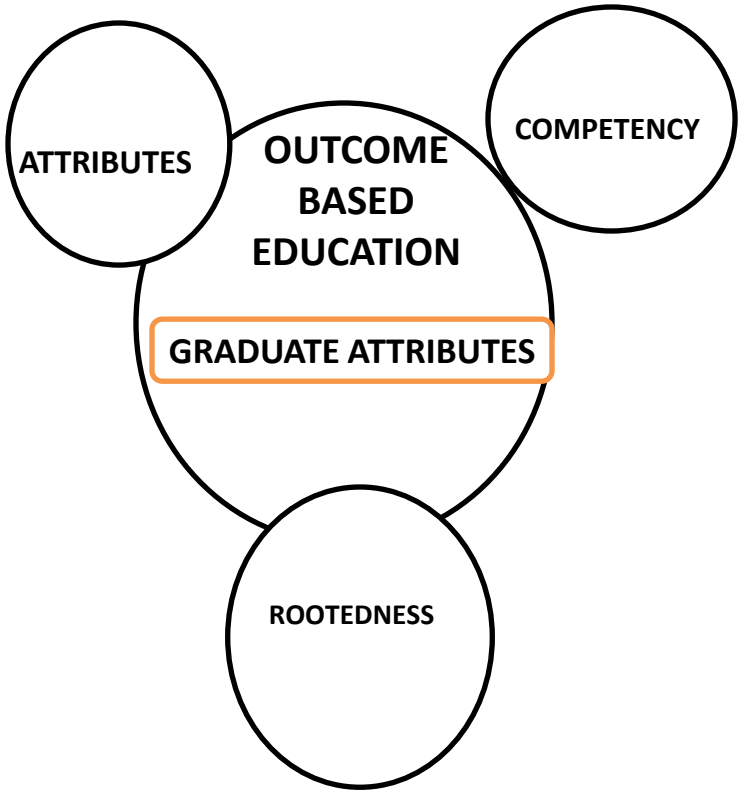
What they do not teach?

Mgt. studies focuses on efficiency; not imagination.

Current business needs managers who are home with both process discipline and creative disorder.

Example?? Selling Ice cubes to Eskimos??? Imagine????

NEP-2020



ATTRIBUTES

1	Critical thinking communication, Negotiation, Reasoning & Decision making for Solving Problems
2	Innovativeness Leadership & Resilience
3	SQ, EQ

COMPETENCY

1	Holistic Knowledge & Skills to perform the Job
2	Domain Knowledge, Ancillary Knowledge
3	Application Skill (Technology & Analysis, Language Skill, Written & Spoken Skill

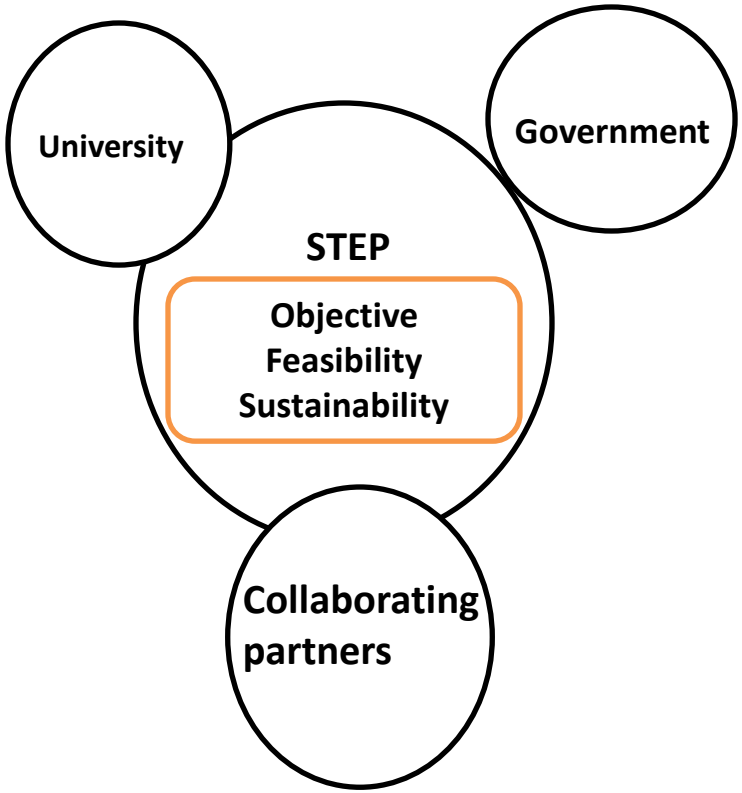
ROOTEDNESS

1	Cultural, Ethical & Social Roots
2	Understanding Constitutional & Democratic Values
3	Env.Soc.Gov.ESG & SDG Understanding along with studies in IKS

Creation of STEP (Science & Technology Entrepreneurs Park – in collaboration with Industries)

University

1	Physical Infrastructure /location/
2	Science base/inno vation
3	Man power/ Ecosystem



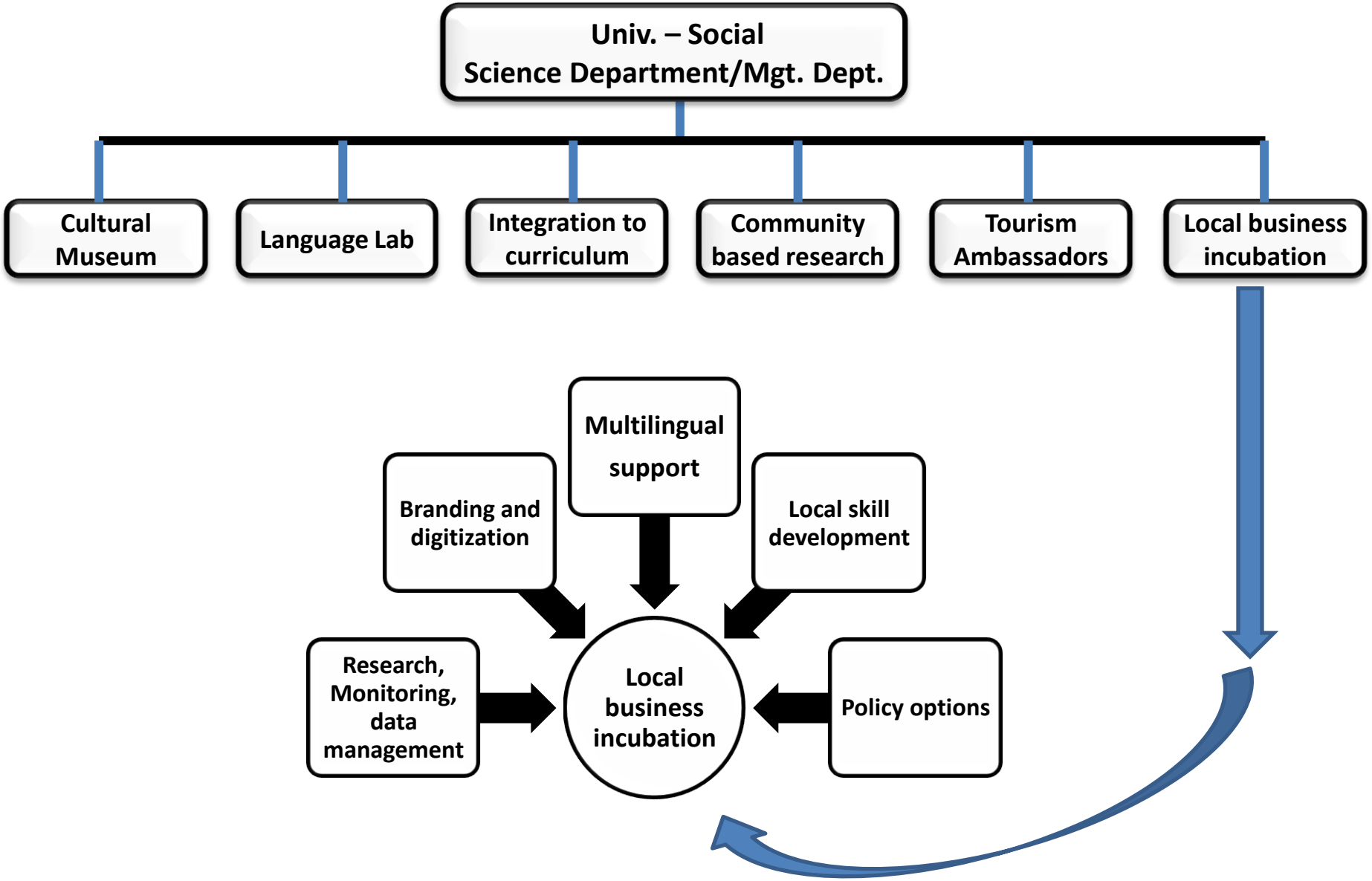
Government

1	Financial Capital
2	Policy Support and & Programme support
3	Connectivity/ networking and Tax incentive

Collaborating Partners (Industry/R&D/Social Organizations)

1	Shared S & T facilities
2	Identification of problems, local needs and joint proposal workout
3	Commercialization of Tech./IPR/guiding strategic technologies

Interdisciplinary centers



Student Support Policies & Frameworks

Policy Directives

Enhances the Students' Self-belief through Constant Mentoring to promote Holistic Development

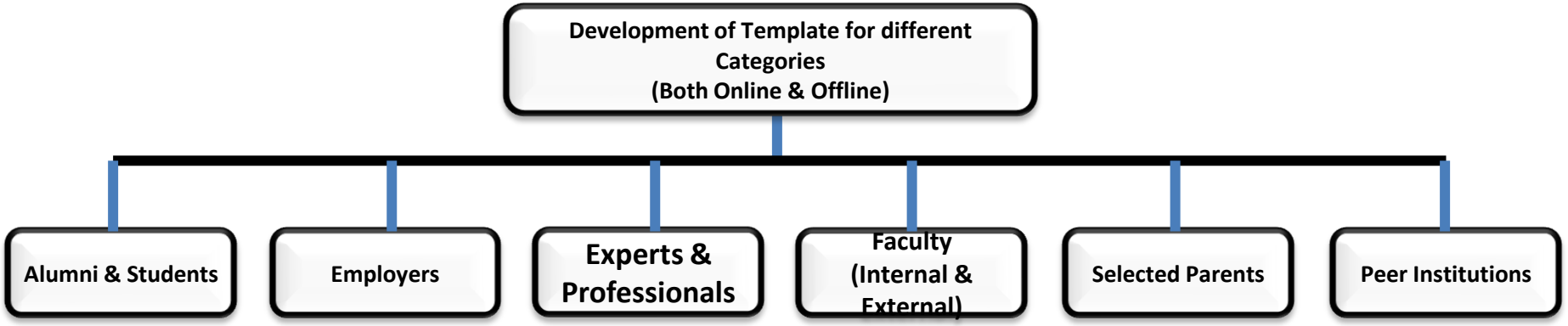
Encourage to move beyond Classroom Engagements like Extracurricular Activities, keeping in consideration the changing Expectations and Aspirations of Students

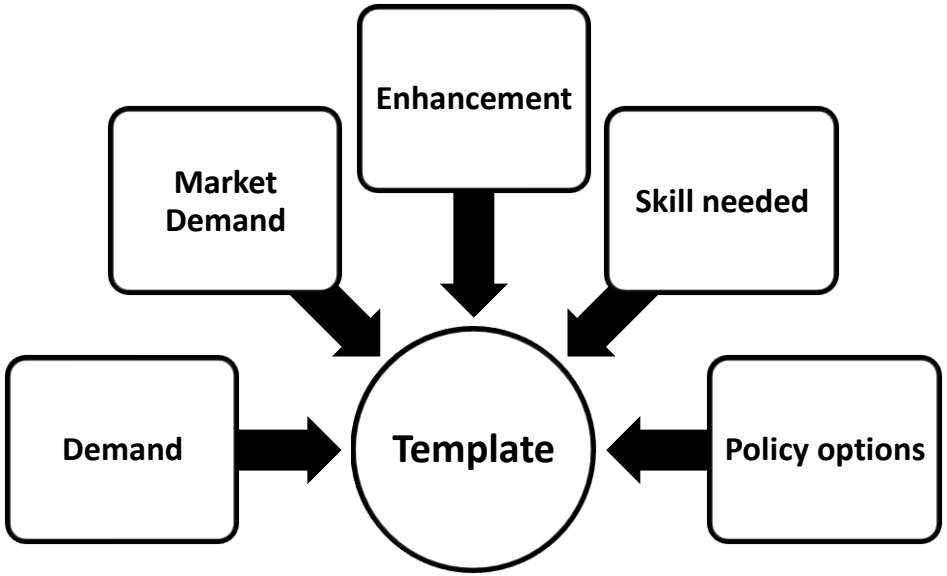
Provides Optimal Learnings Environment, Physical and Mental Wellness, and Ethical grounding through Cultural Sensitization

Core Area of Training
1.Employability and Career
2. Pursuance of Higher Studies
3. Competitive Exam. & Readiness
4. Entrepreneurship Orientation

Capacity and Skill Development Programme
1. Professional Skill (Cognitive and Digital)
2. Domain Specific Skill
3. Interpersonal Skill (Soft Skill and Life Skill)

FEEDBACK SYSTEM & ANALYSIS (courses)



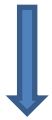


Strategy to accomplish the task

1. To emphasize upon SWOC analysis, Funding, Infrastructure development.
2. Team need to be communicated, motivated, mentored and trained about expected outcome.
3. Focusing upon IDP (Institute Development Plan) & Academic calendar.
4. Identification of various sources of fund mobilization – Industry and Central University collaboration and MoU/Focus upon Executive MBA/ Self Financing courses related to Industry need.
5. Adhere to strict monitoring for timely accomplishment of task and transparency.
6. Projection to achieve the status of and achieving NAAC accreditation/ NIRF ranking/ Ultimate goal is to achieve MERU (Multidisciplinary Education and Research University) through structural & systemic changes, policy reforms and implementation strategies.

What the future could look like?

Exponential Change??



Driven by technology

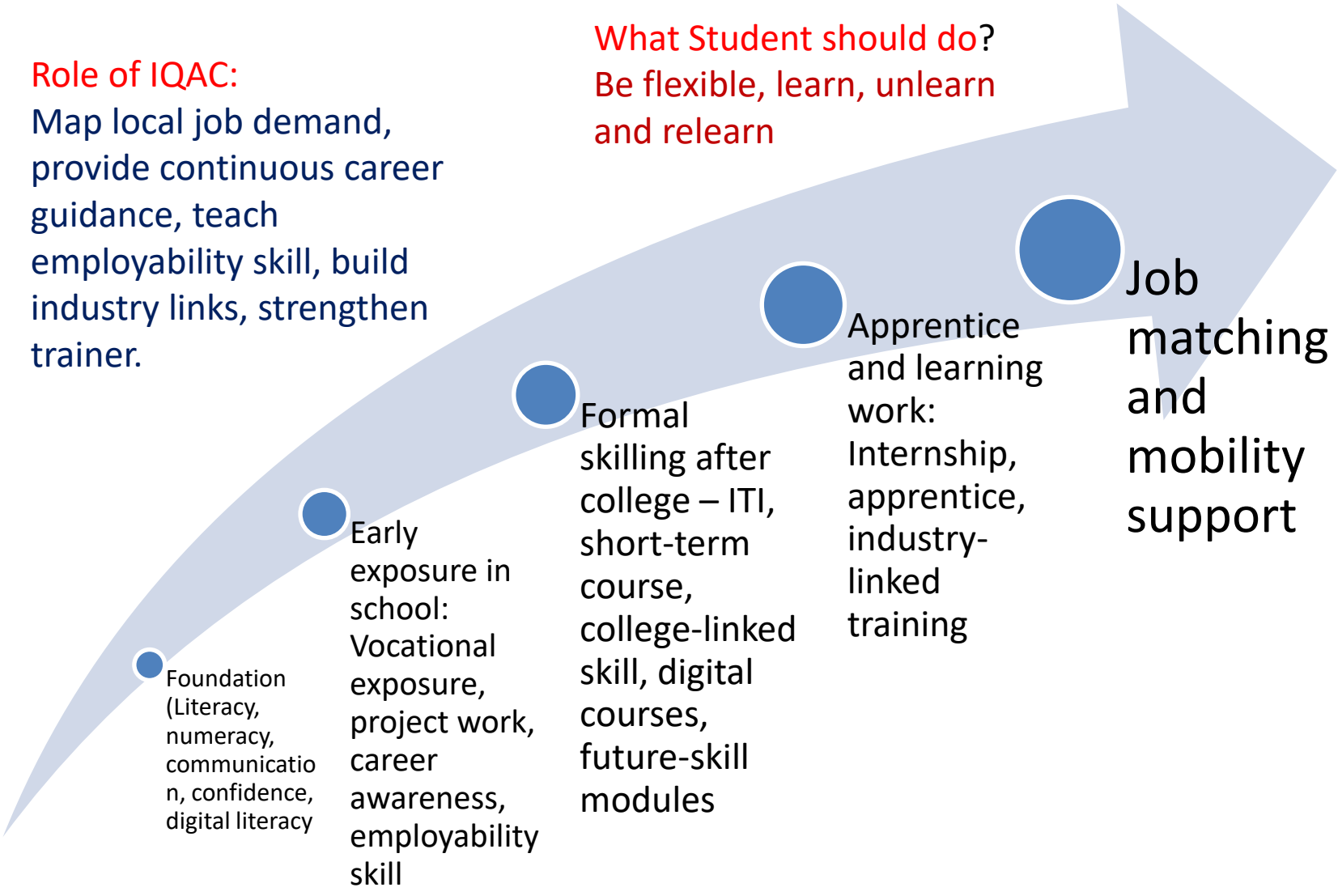
There is a missing link between classroom and job?

1. Transition from education to employment – information gap
2. What college/university teach – Jobs don't need.
3. No one is job ready without work experience.
4. Skilling can not replace the job creation.
5. Why vocational work still lacks respect?
6. For women, the obstacle is often outside the classroom.
7. Should skilling follow local job?
8. Why good skilling ideas stall on the ground?

What exactly our education system should do?

Role of IQAC:
Map local job demand, provide continuous career guidance, teach employability skill, build industry links, strengthen trainer.

What Student should do?
Be flexible, learn, unlearn and relearn



Apprenticeship and Innovation

Whether College or University is necessary to gain practical skills?

Konark, Qutab Minar – build by graduates??????

What HEIs can do ?



HEIs need to nurture imagination and appetite for innovation

Innovation doesn’t happen in silos….

Knowledge has to move beyond paper

Problem …. Project….Paper…Patent…prototype…feedback….Product

Is this kind of transition is possible ???



Possible, through Ph.D.drive programme

How to bridge the disconnection between academia and industry?

✓Industry wants results; academia wants inquiry.

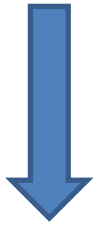
✓Industry guards secrets; Academia like to publish.

Professional technology transfer, Flexible IP policies, Faster and effective MoUs,

Mutual Trust

For Students???

We should stop treating entrepreneurship as an extra-curricular activity.



It must become an academic outcome.

We can tell students it's ok to fail

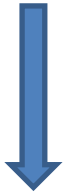
We celebrate the ones who build, not just those who memories.

We give them platform, not degree.

Fuse research, innovation and entrepreneurship.

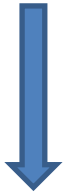
Inspiring
Change makers

Universities/Colleges need more resources



An Academic institution can not file an extra-ordinary number of patents without extra-ordinary investment. Filing, prosecuting and maintain patents need serious money. Converting them to granted patents and then into licensed technologies requires labs, researchers, legal support and sustained funding. If financial investment do not align with public claims, then mismatch will eventually surface.

Quality Research & Publication



Expensive, requires equipments, labs, consumables, and man-power support .

Ranking

Ranking can not be used as shield as it involves reputation of stake-holders.

Enduring reputation is built over decades of consistent work; not through sudden spike in numbers.

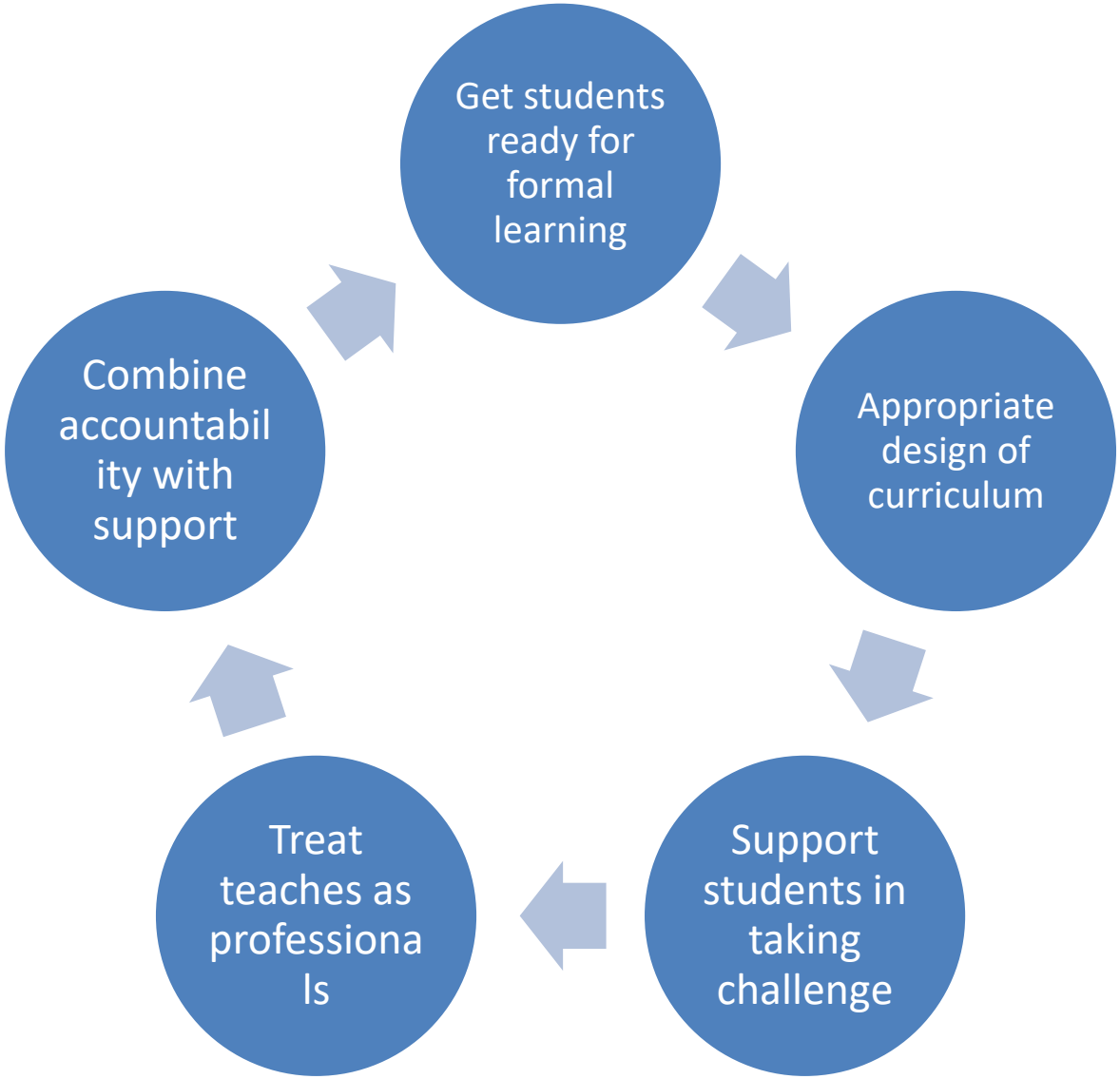
Align claim with capacity.

Make research expenditure and outcome transparent.

Ensure technical claim is validated by faculty.

Encourage depth and real problem solving

Five principles integral to Academics



My conclusion

✓Universities are not ivory towers, but innovation platform.

✓University does not award degree, but solves problems.

✓It re-define success, not by how much one publish; but how much they change the lives.

✓It's a long road.

✓If Institutions like ours takes first steps, I am certain – many will follow.

✓This is time to act by making P.L.A.N.

Policy – Laws (Ordinance/Act/Statute)- Action/Agenda-Nation

Building an Academic Eco-System